

Skills

Establishing and Maintaining a Sterile Field

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Performed hand hygiene before patient contact.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced self to the patient.	☐	☐	☐	
Verified the correct patient using two identifiers. Compared identifiers to the patient's identification bracelet.	☐	☐	☐	
Verified that the procedure required surgical aseptic technique.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed the patient's comfort level, oxygen requirements, and elimination needs before preparing for the procedure.	☐	☐	☐	
To prepare a sterile field, began by checking the expiration date on the sterile packaging. Looked for punctures, tears, stains, and evidence of moisture.	☐	☐	☐	
Anticipated and gathered the necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Selected and prepared a clean, flat, dry work surface above waist level.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene thoroughly, using an alcohol-based hand rub or an antimicrobial soap and water.	☐	☐	☐	
Applied personal protective equipment (PPE) as needed, according to agency's policy.	☐	☐	☐	
Prepared a sterile field using a sterile drape package: 1. Placed the sterile drape package on a clean, dry, flat work surface above waist level. 2. Applied gloves per the organization's practice. Only touched the outer 1-inch border of the drape if not wearing gloves. 3. Opened the outside cover of the sterile drape package. Grasped the folded top edge of the drape with the fingertips of one hand. 4. Gently lifted the drape from its wrapper without allowing it to touch anything. With the other hand, carefully discarded the	☐	☐	☐	

wrapper.

5. Let the drape unfold, holding it away from body and above waist level and the work surface.
6. Then grasped the adjacent corner of the drape and held it straight over the intended work surface.
7. Positioned the bottom half of the drape over the top half of the work surface. Then allowed the top half of the drape to cover the bottom half of the work surface to create a flat sterile field for placement of sterile supplies.

Prepared a sterile field using a commercially packaged sterile kit:

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1. Ensured the kit was intact.
2. Placed the sterile kit on a clean, dry, flat work surface above waist level.
3. Removed and discarded the pull top cover on the sterile kit, exposing the kit's contents.
4. Removed the sterile drape and placed the drape correctly for the procedure.

Prepared a sterile work surface with a commercially packaged sterile kit with an outer wrap:

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1. Ensured the sterile kit was intact.
2. Placed the sterile kit on a clean, dry, flat work surface above waist level.
3. Removed and discarded the plastic dust cover, exposing the contents of the kit.
4. Unfolded the package per the manufacturer's instructions and the agency's practice, generally:
 1. Placed the package on the work surface and positioned it correctly for the procedure so that the package wrapper can become the sterile field.
 2. Grasped the outer surface of the tip of the outermost flap.
 3. Opened this flap away from the body, kept arm outstretched and away from the sterile field.
 4. Grasped the outside surface of the edge of the first side flap.
 5. Opened the side flap, pulling it to the side and allowing it to lie flat on the work surface. Kept arm to the side, not over the sterile field.
 6. Opened the second side flap by pulling it to the side and allowing it to lie flat on the table. Kept arm to the side, not over the sterile field.
 7. Grasped the outside border of the last, innermost flap. Stood away from the sterile package, and pulled the flap back, allowing it to fall flat onto your work surface.
5. Used the opened package wrapper as the sterile field.

Maintained the sterile field.

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Avoided reaching across the sterile field. Did not turn away from the sterile field. Did not leave the room once the sterile field was set up.

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Throughout the procedure, observed for any break in the sterile field.

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If a break occurred, set up a new sterile field.

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Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____